



Sikkim

Towards plentiful harvest

Awards have been the norm of the day for the little Himalayan state of Sikkim under the able guidance of its visionary chief minister, Pawan Chamling. The Nirmal Gram Purashkar 2009, 4th JRD Tata Memorial Award for health achievement 2009, Emerging Tourism State 2008, Most Picturesque Destination 2007 are only a few feather's in the cap worn by the dynamic leader.

The chief architect of Sikkim's emotional integration with the National mainstream, chief minister Chamling's extraordinary success story as a mass based politician is popularly credited to his humility to accept and respect the people as the fountainhead of all power.

The dynamic leader feels economic, social and political equality of women, conservation of the environment, institutionalization of democracy and a trouble-free atmosphere are some of the major achievements of his government. We look at the multi-faceted leader's vision about the hill state of Sikkim.

On Emotional Integration: Pawan Chamling is the first Chief Minister of the State to speak of "emotional integration" of Sikkim with the national mainstream.

"Ours is a perfect example of national integration. Look how our people have become a part of the Indian Union within 33 years. Sikkim can be projected as a role model of national integration." Emotional integration is a phrase coined by Mr Chamling to describe a bonding a state should have with the rest of the country.

He believes people should be allowed to live fearlessly, only then they would be able to come out in their best abilities. He has always maintained, "*Desh hamro Hindustan, Sikkim hamro sukhistan.*" (Our country is India, our happy land is Sikkim). Over the years, feels the chief minister, Sikkim has experienced the process of reverse integration. People from all parts of the country have been looking at Sikkim as a model of mutual co-existence, peace and prosperity.

He has said, "Integration can only come when it is reciprocated by both parties. The rest of the Indian States can learn a lot from Sikkim. We are a leading State in the areas of women's reservation in panchayats and in employment and in conservation of the environment and we have a high rate of growth of gross domestic product (GDP). In this way integration will have to come from them, as Sikkim is willing to show the way by becoming a model State. The whole process will be reciprocated by us."

"My slogan was that India is our country and Sikkim is our home. I am happy that today the people consider themselves Indian and are proud to be Indian."